

National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences
Lahore Campus

Expository Writing Lab (SL1014)

Lab Final Exam

Date: 19th May, 2026.

Total Time: 3:00 Hrs.

Total Marks: 75

Total Questions: 05

Course Instructor(s)

Nokhaiz Zahra	Falaknaz Zia
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Do not write below this line

Instructions: Attempt all the questions on the provided answer sheet in the given sequence. Avoid cutting & overwriting.

CLO # 3 Express ideas with logical and well supported arguments.

Question 1:

[15]

Scenario: You are a 2nd-semester BS Computer Science student at FAST-NUCES, Lahore. During the mid-term exam week, you fell severely ill with acute food poisoning and were hospitalized, forcing you to miss your "Expository Writing" exam held on April 4, 2026. You have obtained a formal medical certificate and hospital discharge slip from the attending physician. According to the university's policy, you need to formally apply to the administration to approve a retake exam on medical grounds.

Question: Write a formal email to **Dr. Mubashir Qayyum** the **Head of the department** (department of sciences and humanities), FAST-NUCES, Lahore, requesting permission to sit for a retake of the **Expository Writing** mid-term exam. In your email, clearly explain the nature of your medical emergency, specify the date of the missed exam, and mention that you have attached the official medical documentation for their verification.

CLO # 4 Write well-structured informational and expository essays.

Question 2: Read the arguments and identify the type of appeals used (ethos, pathos, logos). Provide a detailed justification for your answer by explaining how the language and ideas in the argument support your choice.

[10]

Note: Write your response in a short paragraph of 30-40 words. Each response carries 2.5 marks.

Argument 1:

"As a certified cybersecurity expert with over a decade of experience working with international banks, I

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strongly advise companies to implement multi-factor authentication systems. My professional background in handling large-scale data breaches gives me firsthand insight into how vulnerable unprotected systems can be."

Argument 2:

"Last winter, an entire village was cut off from electricity for ten days during a severe snowstorm. Families burned furniture to stay warm, children missed school, and elderly residents suffered the most. No community should have to endure such hardship again. we must invest in reliable energy infrastructure."

Argument 3:

"Data from a five-year national education survey shows that schools that introduced coding classes in grade 6 saw a 35% increase in students pursuing computer science degrees at university. Furthermore, dropout rates decreased by 12% in those schools."

Argument 4:

"Think about the joy of walking into a clean ocean beach, golden sand, clear blue water, and no plastic waste harming marine life. Now imagine that same beach covered in trash, with sea animals struggling to survive. We must act now to reduce plastic pollution before this beautiful world disappears."

CLO # 3 Express ideas with logical and well supported arguments.

Question 3: Paraphrase the given passage using the guidelines of APA-7 in-text citation. [15]

As more activities move online from banking and shopping to education and healthcare, the risk of cyberattacks continues to increase. Hackers use advanced methods such as fake emails, harmful software, and ransomware to take advantage of weaknesses in computer systems and get illegal access to important and private information. One of the major challenges in cybersecurity is protecting personal and organizational data, as even a single data breach can expose millions of users to financial loss, identity theft, and serious reputational damage. To counter these threats, organizations are investing in stronger security measures such as encryption technologies, firewalls, and multi-factor authentication systems. However, despite technological advancements, human error remains a significant vulnerability because weak passwords, careless clicking on suspicious links, and lack of awareness often provide attackers with easy entry points. For this reason, cybersecurity training and awareness programs are essential for all users, including employees and individuals. Governments also play an important role by enforcing strict cyber laws and regulations to prevent cybercrime and ensure accountability, while international cooperation is necessary because cyber threats frequently cross national borders and require coordinated responses. Ultimately, cybersecurity is not just a technical issue but a shared responsibility that requires a combination of technology, education, and legal frameworks to ensure safety in the digital age.

Reference:

Schneier, B. (2019). *Security and Survival in a Hyper-connected World*. W. W. Norton & Company.

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CLO 4: Write well-structured informational and expository essays

Question 4: Read the given excerpts and write a 5-paragraph Critical Response Essay based on the given article. Your response must include: [25]

- *Introductory paragraph*
- *Body Paragraphs (3)*
- *Concluding Paragraph*

Note: The text given below only serves as the source of information. Do not copy the text, use your own ideas and words.

Read: On April 19, just months after Unitree's dancing humanoid robots captured international headlines for their appearance in the CCTV Spring Festival Gala, Beijing hosted the world's first-ever humanoid robot half marathon. The event drew thousands of live spectators along the course and millions more watching via the CCTV livestream and online platforms, quickly becoming the most widely viewed robotics competitions in history.

Co-organized by Beijing municipal government bureaus, the Beijing Yizhuang Half Marathon and Humanoid Robot Half Marathon marked a milestone in China's push to accelerate humanoid robot development. The event featured 1,200 human runners alongside 20 robot teams from private companies and state-backed projects, including industry leaders Unitree and X-Humanoid. While humans and robots raced on separate tracks, the event podium featured top finishers in both categories — symbolizing Beijing's ambition to integrate humanoid robots into everyday life.

The results revealed that the performance gap between humans and robots remains substantial. While the men's winner finished in 1:02:36 and the women's champion in 1:11:07, Tiangong Ultra, the leading robot, completed the course in 2:40:27. Despite this gap, the event demonstrated the significant technological progress Chinese companies have made in relation to their U.S. counterparts. Tiangong Ultra maintained an average pace of 8.2 km/hr and reached speeds of up to 12 km/hr — surpassing the maximum 8 km/hr demonstrated by Tesla's much-hyped Optimus. Meanwhile, although Boston Dynamics' Atlas is faster than Tiangong Ultra, its battery life is much shorter when performing at maximum capacity.

"This represents a technological and engineering milestone," noted ZongZe Wu, a research associate at Tsinghua University's Institute for Artificial Intelligence International Governance. "Although humanoid robots still have a long way to go, simply completing a course of this distance is a remarkable feat."

Although the event lasted only hours, its symbolism extends far beyond sport. For policymakers and technologists across China, the half-marathon represents a tangible demonstration of the country's accelerating capabilities in "humanoid robotics" and "embodied intelligence". It also marked a turning

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point in a field Beijing has explicitly prioritized as central to its vision of an AI-powered economic transformation – and the beginning of a new era in physical AI applications.

Source:

Written by Leia Wang and Zilan Qian, Published on 21st April 2025

"China's humanoid marathon signals a new kind of AI race" taken from "The Diplomat" magazine.

CLO 4: Write well-structured informational and expository essays

Question 5: Write ONLY the introductory paragraph of the descriptive essay on the following prompt using 50-60 words. [10]

"The University Cafeteria during Lunch Hours"

Your paragraphs should include:

- *Interesting fact*
- *Lead in Statement/s*
- *Three-point thesis statement (focus on Physical, Contextual and Emotional description)*
- *Transitional hook*

Note: The text given below only serves as the source of information. Do not copy the text, use your own ideas and words.

Read:

When a deep, undeniable hunger hits, my mind immediately craves the rich, aromatic world of hearty traditional comfort classics and savory street food. I find myself longing for the irresistible sizzle of flat-top grills, where spiced, tender lentil-and-beef patties are toasted to golden perfection inside warm, soft buns, dripping with tangy tamarind sauce and fresh mint yogurt. If I am looking for something deeply soul-warming, nothing beats a steaming bowl of slow-cooked beef stew, its thick, savory gravy rich with bone marrow and garnished with a mountain of crisp fried onions, fresh ginger, julienned chilies, and a squeeze of fresh lime, scooped up with a pillowy, hot clay-oven flatbread. On other days, my cravings pivot to the vibrant crunch of a street-style pastry bowl, where flaky, potato-filled savory turnovers are crushed under a warm blanket of spiced chickpea curry, cool yogurt, and a sprinkle of tangy spice mix. Whether it is a rich, slow-simmered traditional feast or a quick, fiery bite from a bustling street corner, these foods do more than just quiet a rumbling stomach—they deliver a powerful, satisfying punch of pure comfort.

-----The End-----